

MyEscrow addresses a broad transaction problem: how independent parties manage staged payments in project-based work.

The opportunity spans freelance, agency, professional-service, marketplace, and construction transactions where scope, delivery, and payment occur over time. The market question is whether enough higher-value projects need added controls—and whether users will pay for them.

INTERPRETATION

Adjacent indicators, not a TAM

No authoritative dataset directly measures U.S. demand for milestone escrow across project-based services. These figures establish participant scale, financial friction, and vertical context—not addressable revenue.

U.S. LABOUR SIGNAL

11.9 million

Independent contractors

In July 2023, independent contractors—including consultants and freelance workers—represented 7.4% of U.S. employment on a sole or main job. This is a participant pool, not a count of escrow-ready users.¹

SMALL-BUSINESS SIGNAL

51%

Reported uneven cash flow

In the Federal Reserve Banks' 2024 survey, 51% of employer firms cited uneven cash flow—including collecting receivables—as a challenge. Escrow can clarify payment conditions, but prefunding may create a different liquidity burden.²

RISK CONTEXT

\$16 billion

Reported U.S. fraud losses in 2025

FTC data show reported losses across all fraud categories reached about \$16 billion. Most falls outside MyEscrow's proposed use cases; only a subset of transaction losses may be preventable by escrow.³

CONSTRUCTION CONTEXT

\$2.21 trillion

Annualized U.S. construction activity

Construction put in place reached a \$2.21 trillion annual rate in May 2026; 18.5% of construction-industry workers were independent contractors in July 2023. Neither figure measures escrow demand.^{1,4}

USE CASE · CONTRACTED SERVICES

Freelance, agency, and professional work

- Website, software, creative, or marketing work delivered by milestone
- Consulting engagements with defined outputs and acceptance criteria
- Agency projects involving independent specialists or subcontractors

USE CASE · CONSTRUCTION

General contractors and project draws

- Owner-to-GC progress payments tied to documented stages
- GC-to-subcontractor releases following work approval
- Change-order, retainage, and lien-waiver records around payment events

USE CASE · PLATFORMS AND COMMERCE

Transactions lacking native protection

- Service marketplaces without milestone or dispute infrastructure
- Custom goods using deposit, inspection, and delivery stages
- Higher-value private transactions requiring verification before release

COMMON WORKFLOW AND BOUNDARY

What the use cases share

Parties agree scope, fund the transaction, submit delivery evidence, approve or request revision, and release, refund, or dispute funds. The best fit has identifiable parties and objective stages; immediate, low-value, anonymous, or highly regulated transactions are weaker candidates.

Sources: ¹ U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, [Contingent and Alternative Employment Arrangements, July 2023](#). ² Federal Reserve Banks, [2025 Report on Employer Firms](#). ³ Federal Trade Commission, [2025 fraud-loss data](#). ⁴ U.S. Census Bureau, [Value of Construction Put in Place, May 2026](#). Figures are contextual indicators, use different populations and periods, and should not be added together.